

French A1 — Week 1 Student Overview

Crescere | Beginner French | Week 1

Welcome to your first week of French.

What You Will Learn This Week

This week is about getting your voice into French. You will not be fluent by the end of Week 1 — that is not the goal. The goal is to feel what it is like to say real French words, to be corrected and try again, and to end the week with something you can actually say to another person.

Here is what we will cover:

- **How French sounds.** French uses sounds that do not exist in English — a throaty r, vowels through the nose, silent consonants at the ends of words. You will hear these and try them in Session 1. They feel strange at first. That is completely normal. They become easier with practice.
 - **How to greet someone.** Formal and informal. When to say *tu* and when to say *vous*.
 - **How to say who you are.** Your name, where you're from, where you live, and what you do.
 - **The verb *être* (to be).** The most important verb in French. You will learn three forms this week — *je suis, tu es, il/elle est* — and use them in real sentences.
 - **Numbers 1–100.** You will learn 1–20 in Session 1. The rest are in the homework files with the full patterns explained.
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What You Will Be Able to Say by Friday

By the end of Session 2, you should be able to say something like:

Bonjour, je m'appelle [name]. Je suis de [city/country]. J'habite à [city]. Je suis [profession]. Je suis [nationality].

Hello, my name is [name]. I'm from [city/country]. I live in [city]. I'm a [profession]. I'm [nationality].

You will also be able to ask someone else:

Comment tu t'appelles ? Tu es d'où ? Tu fais quoi dans la vie ?

What's your name? Where are you from? What do you do for work?

That is enough for a real exchange with another person. Session 1 gives you the building blocks; Session 2 puts them together into a conversation.

What to Practice Between Sessions

After Session 1 — before Session 2:

1. **Say your introduction out loud at least three times.** In the mirror, in the car, wherever. The goal is to say it without looking at your notes. It will feel less strange each time.
2. **Practice numbers 1–30.** They are in your Session 1 homework. Count up, then count down, then count by fives.
3. **Glance at the alphabet reference.** You do not need to memorize it before Session 2. Just know it is there — you will use it to spell words aloud later in the course.

After Session 2 — before Session 3:

1. **Work through the numbers 31–100.** Your Session 2 homework has the full patterns with explanations. The 70s and 80s–90s look strange — read the logic behind them and they will make sense.
 2. **Write your five-sentence introduction in French.** Instructions are in the Session 2 homework.
 3. **Say your introduction out loud from memory** at least once.
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A Note on Expectations

This course is taught speaking-first. That means Session 1 will feel fast. You will hear things you cannot yet reproduce perfectly. You will be asked to speak before you feel ready.

That is the method. It is intentional.

Speaking a new language feels awkward, and every person in your cohort is in the same position. Your instructor expects mistakes — that is how the class works. The only thing that does not help is staying quiet.

Say it wrong, get corrected, say it again. That is the whole process.

Vocabulary to Know Before Week 2

You will find the full Week 1 vocabulary list in your Week 1 Vocabulary Reference. The most important items for Session 3 (the start of Week 2) are:

- Your complete introduction: name, origin, city, profession, nationality
- Basic greetings and their register (formal vs. informal)
- *Je suis / tu es / il-elle est* — the three être forms from Week 1
- Numbers 1–30 (solid) and the pattern for 31–100 (understood)

You do not need to have the full six-form être conjugation memorized before Week 2. That is what Week 2 is for.

Crescere — French A1 Week 1 / Questions? Contact your instructor.